Project Report

Digital Literacy

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INTRODUCTION

This project is part of my role as a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, where I worked on creating a Digital Literacy Portfolio to help fellow students use technology in a smarter and more responsible way. The assignment is divided into five tasks, each connected to different modules from the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course.

In Task 1, I designed a visual infographic to spread awareness about digital literacy. Task 2 involved creating and improving my professional presence on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. In Task 3, I explored coding practice websites and learned how to use Google Workspace tools for collaboration. Task 4 helped me understand professional email writing and proper social media behaviour. Finally, Task 5 focused on cybercrime awareness, where I worked on a case study and created a prevention checklist.

All my work has been organized and uploaded to a GitHub repository, which will serve as a part of my long-term digital portfolio. Through this project, I not only completed the tasks but also gained practical skills that I can use in my academic journey and future career.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I used Canva to create my final design. I chose Canva because it is easy to use and offers many templates, icons, and design elements that helped me present my ideas neatly. It allowed me to experiment with colours, fonts, and layouts without making the process too complicated.

My design focuses on the five components of digital literacy—information literacy, communication and collaboration, digital safety, technical skills, and digital ethics. I presented each component in a clear and simple way so that anyone can quickly understand the key ideas. I also tried to make the design visually appealing by using icons and balanced spacing to highlight each point.

One thing I found a bit challenging was arranging everything so that it looked clean and not too crowded. At the same time, it was interesting to explore different design options and see how small changes could improve the overall look. This task helped me become more creative and confident in using digital tools like Canva.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I chose to set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle—three platforms that serve distinct but complementary purposes in my academic and professional journey.

GitHub is primarily a code hosting and collaboration platform. It allows me to showcase my programming projects, track my learning progress, and eventually contribute to open-source software. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as my central portfolio, uploading assignments, mini-projects, and my final year project. By my final year, I aim to have at least 10 well-documented repositories that demonstrate my technical growth to potential employers.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I can connect with industry professionals, professors, and alumni. I will use it to stay updated on internship opportunities, share my academic achievements, and build my

personal brand. My goal is to gradually expand my network, starting with my batchmates and seniors, and eventually connecting with recruiters and professionals in my field of interest.

Kaggle is a data science platform where I can practice machine learning through real-world datasets and competitions. Over four years, I plan to complete Kaggle's certification courses, participate in competitions, and build a portfolio of analysis notebooks. This will help me gain practical skills that are highly valued in today's data-driven industries.

Together, these platforms will help me build a strong digital presence that reflects both my technical abilities and professional growth throughout my college years.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This task gave me two very different but equally valuable experiences—one that challenged how I think, and another that showed me how simple tools can make work much more efficient.

I started with HackerRank, a platform I had heard about but never really explored. At first, it felt a bit intimidating to begin coding problems on my own, but the Python Beginners challenge turned out to be a great introduction. It wasn’t just about finding the correct answer; it was about understanding the logic behind it. As I continued, I realized that coding is less about memorizing syntax and more about learning how to break problems down step by step.

The second part of the task involved creating a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” using Google Forms. I added five questions, including multiple-choice, short-answer types and long answer type, and linked the responses to Google Sheets. Seeing the responses automatically organized in a spreadsheet I was amazed as to how easily it showed the usefulness these tools can be for managing data.

Overall, this task helped me see that programming improves with consistent practice, and that tools like Google Workspace can make academic work more organized, efficient, and collaborative.

Task 4: Email Etiquette & Social Media Checklist

Case Study: When Poor Digital Communication Causes a Problem

In one instance, a student sent a brief, text-heavy email to their professor requesting an assignment extension. The subject line was missing, the greeting read "Hey," and the message simply said, "I can't submit the assignment. Give me more time." There was no mention of the course name, assignment details, or a valid reason for the delay. The professor, feeling the tone was casual and demanding, declined the request. This led to unnecessary stress for the student, who had actually been genuinely unwell but failed to communicate that effectively.

What could have been done differently: A clear subject line, a respectful greeting, a brief explanation of the situation, and a polite request with a specific extension timeline would have made all the difference. Professional email etiquette shows respect and accountability, which increases the likelihood of receiving support.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Before this, I'll be honest , I thought cybercrime was something that mostly caught people who simply didn't know better. If you were reasonably careful and digitally aware, you'd be fine. This research changed that assumption pretty quickly.

What struck me most wasn't the sophistication of the scams. It was the opposite, actually. The simplest tactics are often the most effective. A message that creates just enough panic. Caller who sounds calm, professional, and completely trustworthy. Scammers don't need to outsmart you ; they just need to catch you on a busy day when your guard is down for thirty seconds.

So the change I'm making isn't a dramatic one, but I think it matters: I'm going to slow down. Before clicking a link, before responding to a message that feels urgent, before entering any payment or personal information. It sounds

simple, but that small habit is exactly what these scams are designed to bypass.

This task reminded me that online safety isn't really a one-time lesson. It's less about what you know and more about how present you are in the moment. Awareness without attention isn't enough and that's the part I hadn't fully appreciated before.

CONCLUSION

Working on this Digital Literacy project as a Student Digital Ambassador genuinely changed how I think about the digital world.

Each task taught me something different. Building an infographic sharpened my ability to communicate ideas visually. Setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle made me realize how much a professional online presence matters — recruiters are paying attention. The HackerRank challenge pushed me to keep going with programming, and creating a Google Form quiz showed me how simple tools can make collaboration so much easier.

Writing professional emails was a small but valuable lesson — a clear subject line and a respectful tone really do make a difference. But the cybercrime task hit hardest. Learning about phishing and UPI fraud made me realize how vulnerable people around me are, especially since most students have never even heard of the Cyber Crime Helpline 1930. That's something I want to change.

By the end of it all, I had a GitHub portfolio, stronger digital skills, and a lot more confidence heading into my academic and professional future.